

LIFE ENHANCEMENT

sport, it has its own rewards. For an athlete, the search for excellence helps you discover things about yourself, unearth facets of your personality that you never knew existed. It comes with a huge amount of job satisfaction and the knowledge that despite everything, you tried to be the best you could be.

India has changed, in some spheres almost beyond recognition, since the time I first picked up a cricket bat. We have achieved much in recent years in terms of economic growth and there is much to be proud of, but we can be and do more. It is almost as if India must now become the athlete striving for excellence. This starting point, of demanding excellence from yourself or always wanting to do better, is where I think the country can transform itself and can change in a very real way, with every citizen wanting the best out of themselves and then, as a natural progression, wanting and expecting no less from the world around him.

I find that as Indians, collectively, we have a resigned attitude to everything around us. This attitude is at odds with the personal enterprise and energy that is found in every street corner. As a people, we have this habit of accepting everything and not expecting better: from ourselves, from our surroundings, from our politicians, judges, police, and those who govern us. We fall quickly into our own 'comfort zones', of just being content to live in our own safe little worlds, of houses, jobs and families. I believe as Indians we're all connected to our circumstances. Think only of yourself, your family and your life and not the wider community you live in. You'll realise that the community and neighbourhood will be chaotic, shambolic, like most of our cities are today.

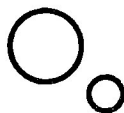
By not being involved in the world immediately around us, what we are actually doing is passively accepting corruption, poor policing, bad hospitals, substandard infrastructure, inadequate disaster management. We complain, strongly of course, that the government, judiciary and police is bad but there is a big difference between demanding and complaining. We think they are the same but they're not.

We must demand better infrastructure but not complain if the roads are being dug up to build a flyover or a metro. We must demand that our cities be more secure but stop



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INDIAN COMPANIES MADE IT TO THE GLOBAL LIST OF TOP COMPANIES FOR LEADERS IN 2007, ACCORDING TO A HEWITT ASSOCIATES SURVEY.



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